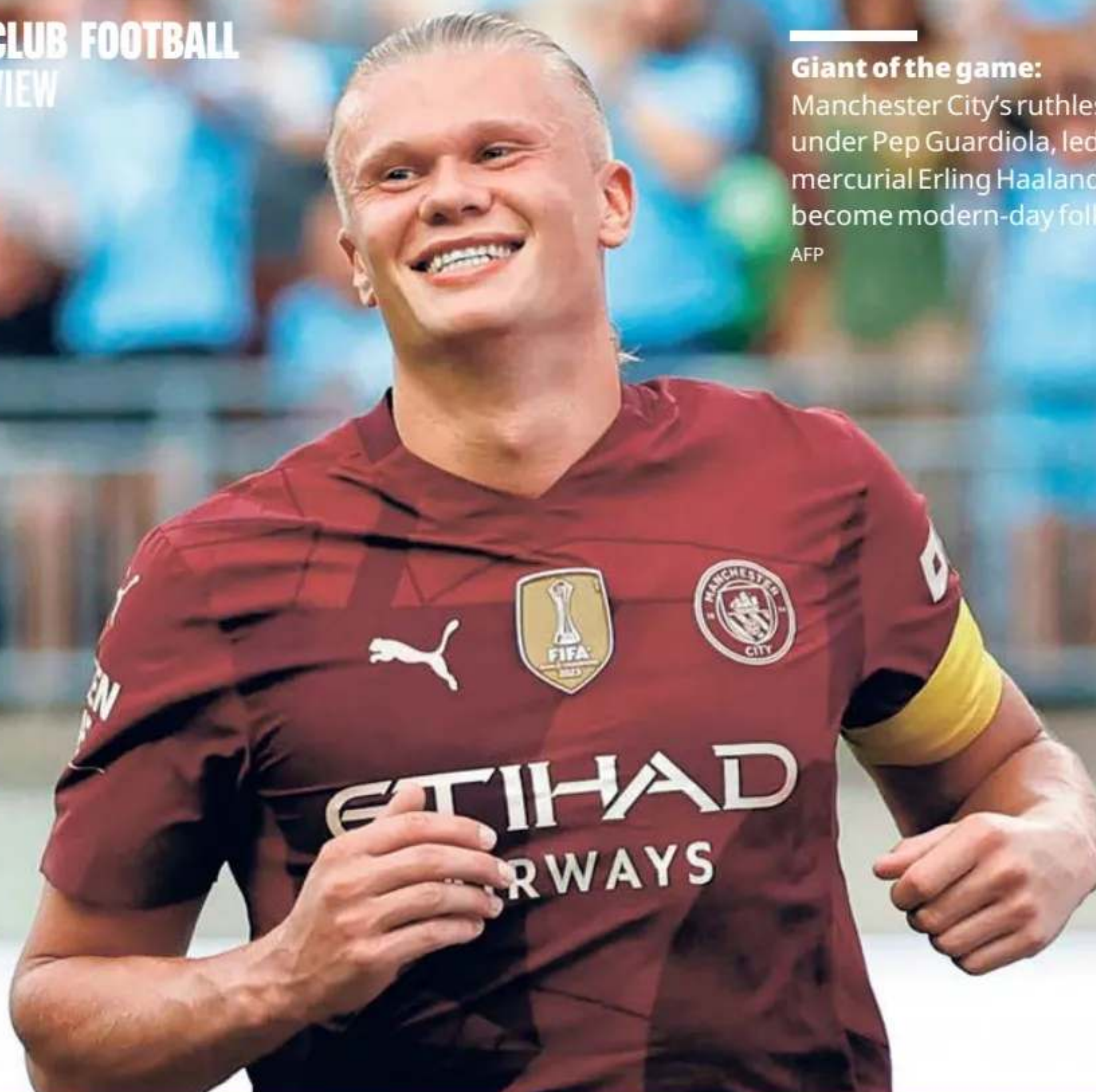


Giant of the game:

Manchester City's ruthlessness under Pep Guardiola, led by the mercurial Erling Haaland, has become modern-day folklore.

AFP



ALL SET FOR KICK-OFF!

From Manchester City's quest for a fifth consecutive Premier League title to Real Madrid's Galáctico-like makeover, there's **no dearth of subplots** in the upcoming European club season.

Aneesh Dey

aneesh.dey@thehindu.co.in



FOR MORE
STORIES

The European Championship is over, the Copa America is over, and pre-season is almost over. Soon, club football will return in full glory as teams across Europe begin their battle to reign supreme. Will Kylian Mbappé cement his legacy in the Royal White? Will Harry Kane finally win a trophy? The 2024-25 season has plenty to offer.

Premier League

Manchester City has reigned supreme in recent times, making history by winning the league four years in a row. The law of averages

suggests that Pep Guardiola's men should falter at some stage, given their undisputed dominance. However, City's ruthlessness under Guardiola has become modern-day folklore.

With the manager's contract ending in June 2025, there are rising questions about his future at the club. If the next season is to be his last, he will want to bow out on a high and win his seventh Premier League title with the Cityzens.

The team most likely to be hot on City's heels is Mikel Arteta's Arsenal. The Gunners have provided a stern challenge to City's title hopes for the last two seasons, only to falter at crucial stages, aiding City's ascendancy.

Arteta's project has demanded patience, and the fans have seen the team reap the benefits, albeit in patches. The 2024-25 season will be a